

Facility Lockdown Guide

A facility lockdown may be implemented under the following conditions at, or near, the facility:

- An off-site armed aggressor such as a police stand-off or shoot out.
- An unarmed aggressor on-site, including workplace violence.
- An active shooter or armed aggressor on-site.
- A security breach of the facility.
- Potential or occurring civil disorder.
- As a result of a natural disaster.
- If a major health and safety hazard is identified on site.
- In the event of an identified suspect explosive device.

In the event of a potential (or reported) threat to a site, or if an attack or intrusion is actually occurring, then the guard force or the facility management team may be required to secure the perimeter, access control points, and critical assets and structures, as well as ensure the safety and security of personnel and visitors in the area. This will not only enable the guard force or the facility management team to better protect the site and people but will also enable security or other appropriate personnel to more easily identify hostile or unauthorized intruders.

In the event of a natural disaster, including an earthquake or flood, then site lockdowns may also occur.

Purpose of the Emergency Lockdown Protocol

The purpose of an emergency lockdown protocol is to minimize accessibility to the site, the facilities within the site, and to minimize the risk of injury or danger to people. A lockdown may be implemented:

- As a proactive measure should there be a perceived threat or alert before an attack, intrusion or other threat event occurs.
- As a responsive measure to an occurring threat, attack, intrusion or other critical incident or crisis event.

The decision to lockdown is normally determined by the most senior security representative on-site, or as ordered by a higher authority (including external security forces or law enforcement).

Management Considerations

It is important for the Local Incident Management Team (LIMT) to consider what they are seeking to protect against and accomplish during a lockdown. The LIMT may use two types of lockdowns to protect people, facilities, assets, and information:

- **Preventative Lockdown:** A preventive lockdown is where a threat is reported or has been identified but has not yet occurred and a measured approach can be adopted.
- **Emergency Lockdown:** An emergency lockdown is where there is imminent or occurring threat and where the LIMT may need to implement an immediate 'no notice' lockdown.

The management team should be sure that lockdowns can be self-directed by site security personnel or other appropriate personnel, as well as directed by higher and sometimes external authorities. This is important for situations where guards or staff detect danger before they have an opportunity to request permission from the management team to secure the area. The guard force or facility staff should be instructed to alert the senior security representative on site once they have implemented an independent lockdown, explaining their rationale.

Preventative Emergency Lockdown Situations

Preventative site lockdowns may occur where the threat conditions are elevated, where risks are reported, but where an attack or intrusion has not yet occurred. It may also be used where a natural disaster or humanmade hazard has been identified but has not yet occurred. The following considerations are associated with such lockdowns:

- Can critical activities continue in a safe and secure manner, and what security measures are required to accomplish these. What non-critical activities should be stopped.
- Is a partial or full lockdown required. Can parts of the facility continue operations safely.
- What access control restrictions are required to reflect the reported risks, should limitations on visitors, workers and staff operations be implemented.
- Should personnel be evacuated from the site; either in a staged manner or as a single group.
- Should vehicle and personnel searching be implemented (or increased) to look for weapons and explosives.
- What additional security measures are required for perimeter, access control, patrol and critical area or asset protection. Are extra resources and security personnel required.
- What briefings should be provided to security and non-security staff in terms of the threat and emergency response protocols.
- Are Quick Reaction Force or QRF teams ready to respond (if in place), are crisis communications tested and operating.
- Should external agencies and forces be engaged to support security and safety measures. When and how will this be implemented.

Emergency Lockdown Situations

Emergency lockdowns are implemented if a threat is confirmed, or is actually occurring, to protect people, facilities, information and assets so that intruders can be identified and the situation managed quickly and effectively. The following considerations apply:

- Who or what is at risk and how can these vulnerable people, locations, assets or information be secured.
- How can perimeter, access control, and critical structures and assets be secured in a fast and effective manner.
- How can non-security personnel be secured with least exposure to risk and be removed from an affected area so that intruders can be quickly identified and engaged.
- How can guards and staff report their positions are secured, or that critical assets and structures are protected.
- How can guards report that staff, visitors, and workers have been secured, or where they are at risk.
- How can non-security staff be evacuated safely and effectively from an area of risk.
- How can guards establish dominating positions to identify intruders or attackers.
- How can responding forces be met (such as at an Incident Control Point or ICP) and briefed on their responsibilities and the situation.
- How can a stand-down protocol be implemented once the threat has passed.
- How can security structures and technologies be best used and can these be accessed by responding security and law enforcement personnel.

Key Lockdown Principles

The following key principles apply to management teams and guards during lockdown events:

- All security personnel must be prepared to implement life-saving and life-protecting procedures during an emergency situation.
- All security personnel should understand how to secure perimeters, access control points, critical structures and assets, as well as people.
- The means of operating the alarm notification system, whether by Public Address or building or whole-site alarms (including sirens, klaxons, alarms, or verbal notification systems) or radios

should be understood by all security personnel, and the responses to the alarms must be understood by all staff and long-term contractors, being drilled regularly.

- The **Use of Force** and **Rules of Engagement** protocols (collectively, the Rules on the Use of Preventive Force) should be understood by all guard force personnel [if used], and clear and explicit instructions should be issued during an emergency.
- Site lockdown drills and exercises should be carried out on a regular basis so that guards and other personnel can understand their responsibilities.
- Key buildings and asset locations should have lockdown capability and should be able to be robustly secured.
- Site emergency lockdown plans should also take into account the possibility of having visitors or workers on site. Short-term contractors and visitors need to know what to do in an emergency.
- Effective communications (both internal and external) are needed for lockdowns and other possible emergency incidents.
- External supporting agencies should be immediately notified.
- Security positions at access control points and within any established cordons should formally report to the Operations Room or Security Office (if in place) when they have implemented their lock down responsibilities.

Cordoning and Incident Control Points

Placing a cordon around a location or work area enables management teams to exercise a degree of control otherwise not available to them if a cordon were not in place. A cordon is a useful tool to enable sufficient access and exit controls to a temporarily restricted area, particularly in the lead up to and during emergencies, or during an investigation.

If a cordon is not executed and managed well it could potentially impede, or worst still, damage operations or endanger people. Conversely, if a cordon is implemented and managed well, it will help potentially preserve life and property, protect a sensitive site, secure evidence for an investigation, and enable the appropriate authorities to best conduct and manage operations.

Cordon implementation and management comprises of a number of essential components, including understanding the nature and likely usage of cordons, the need for good command and control, and the need for effective and efficient communications at all times.

Incident Control Points (ICPs) are areas where command and control is implemented and where responding agencies are met, briefed and led into the site.

The Nature and Use of Cordons

A cordon is the enclosing and guarding of a designated area. In general, the purpose of a cordon is to control the movement of people, vehicles and materials in and out of a designated area. The context for a cordon is normally, but not exclusively, designed to facilitate support to emergency, security, health and safety operations, and possibly as a pre-emptive action in support of pending operations. It may also be used in the event of a release of hazardous materials or during an investigation.

- **Command and Control (C²):** A clear command and control structure should be established by the LIMT, and that structure should be known to all guard force and facility management personnel involved in an incident. Such a structure will help facilitate the timely and methodical application of cordon procedures. All members of the cordon team should be aware of the command structure as well as their own roles and responsibilities in managing a restricted area with defined entry points.
- **Transferring Command and Control:** The transfer of command may occur with an initial response team taking command of a situation, before transferring command to a more senior or more specialist team when they arrive, including external emergency responders. Such transfers should be measured to ensure that the transition is seamless, rather than being rushed and ineffective. The Cordon Commander should ensure a full transfer of knowledge occurs before relinquishing command, and that all cordon guards are notified of the transition of responsibility.

Cordon Management

The LIMT may be responsible (until primacy has been ceded to external emergency responders) for securing the area. This will typically comprise three phases:

- **Cordon:** To ensure no-one on site is placed at risk through straying into areas that, as a result of the incident, may continue to present danger. The affected area – where this is possible – should be physically cordoned using marker tape, and the cordon should be patrolled by clearly identifiable guards.
- **Clear:** Once a cordon has been established the area within the cordon must be cleared as far as it is safe to do so. This may involve guards or other appropriate personnel moving in to the area to escort people out of the area, or physically move casualties to a point of safety. If the area is fundamentally unsafe then it may only possible to clear an area through the use of public announcement or emergency alarm system.
- **Control:** Control over the incident must be established with utmost speed. In practical terms, this is done by making an early decision as to where the ICP is to be located and the nomination of a Cordon Commander. The remainder of the LIMT should be convened in a second location, removed from close proximity to the incident site and with access to the full range of information and communications necessary manage a crisis. This may be the Operations Room, Security Office, or a conference room.

MAPPING AND IMAGERY (IF REQUIRED)
